

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 936

By Yager

A RESOLUTION to honor and recognize Samuel Milton Leslie on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to honor those individuals who have answered a divine call to the ministry and have served with dedication, vigor, and enthusiasm to perform God's work for their congregations and communities; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is Samuel Milton Leslie, Minister of Music at South Harriman Baptist Church, who is taking his much-deserved retirement following thirty years of devout service in that role; and

WHEREAS, born on December 27, 1956, in Jackson, Mr. Leslie was raised in a Christian home with two older sisters; the family attended worship services led by his grandfather at a south Georgia Baptist church; and

WHEREAS, his mother was involved in music and youth activities at their church, led a puppet team, and enjoyed participating in national and international missions; his father, a World War II Army veteran, worked for South Central Bell; and

WHEREAS, Sam Leslie was saved at the age of seventeen following a mission trip to North Jackson Baptist Church; during his first year at college, he felt called into full-time Christian service, and he was ordained in January 1986 at Mignon Baptist Church in Alabama; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Leslie earned his Associate of Science degree in Music from Jackson State Community College, his Bachelor of Music degree in Sacred Music with a minor in Music Theory from Union University, and his Master of Church Music degree with a major in Voice and a minor in Youth Ministry from The Southern Baptist Theological Seminary; and

WHEREAS, in his mission to help others in developing their relationship with God, Sam Leslie has served in music ministry, youth ministry, senior adult ministry, and mission trips throughout his life; he has enjoyed leading Vacation Bible Schools, the Judgment House, and youth conferences with the Big Emory Baptist Association; and

WHEREAS, his professional ministry experience began in 1976, when he served as Minister of Youth at Highland Park Baptist Church in Jackson, concluding that tenure in 1978, the year he went on a summer mission trip to New Hampshire and accepted the position of Minister of Youth at North Jackson Baptist Church; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Leslie became interim Minister of Music at Hillcrest Baptist Church in Jackson in 1982 and served as Minister of Music and Youth at Fordsville Baptist Church in Kentucky from 1983 to 1985, at which time he relocated to Mignon Baptist Church in Sylacauga, Alabama, to serve as Minister of Music and Education from 1985 to 1995; and

WHEREAS, returning home to Tennessee, he began his tenure as Minister of Music at South Harriman Baptist Church in 1996, and since that time, he has served the people of his congregation with enthusiasm and dedication, inspiring many through the power of worship music; and

WHEREAS, a vocalist himself, Mr. Leslie has lent his vocal talents to the Alabama Singing Men of the Alabama Baptist State Board of Missions and currently enjoys his ministry with the Tennessee Men's Chorale of the Tennessee Baptist Mission Board; and

WHEREAS, his professional accomplishments aside, he has been blessed with the love and support of his wife, Leigh Ann Leslie, and their two sons, Aaron and Daniel, who serve full-time in ministry; and

WHEREAS, Samuel Leslie has continued to demonstrate excellence in his calling as a man of God; the members of his congregation have been proud to call him their minister and friend; and

WHEREAS, a true shepherd of the flock, Mr. Leslie has an abiding love for the ministry; his many contributions to his church, his community, and this State are deeply appreciated, and it is wholly fitting that he be recognized on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Samuel Milton Leslie on the occasion of his retirement, thank him for his meritorious service as Minister of Music at South Harriman Baptist Church, and extend to him our best wishes for every future success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.